

Website UI Redesign – Heuristic Evaluation

Website Evaluated: Craigslist

Heuristic Evaluation

1. Visibility of System Status

The website provides limited feedback when users perform actions. Some buttons and links do not clearly indicate that an action has been completed, making users unsure whether the website is responding.

Issue: Lack of visual feedback after user actions.

Suggested Improvement: Add loading indicators, success messages, and highlighted buttons.

2. Match Between System and the Real World

The website uses a simple structure, but some category names and navigation labels are not immediately clear for new users.

Issue: Some terms may confuse first-time visitors.

Suggested Improvement: Use more user-friendly labels and simple language.

3. User Control and Freedom

Users can navigate between pages, but there are limited options to undo actions or quickly return to previous pages.

Issue: Navigation feels restrictive.

Suggested Improvement: Add clear Back buttons and breadcrumbs for easier navigation.

4. Consistency and Standards

The website has inconsistent spacing, fonts, and layout across different sections, making the interface feel outdated.

Issue: Lack of visual consistency.

Suggested Improvement: Use consistent fonts, colors, button styles, and spacing throughout the website.

5. Error Prevention

The website allows users to submit forms with limited guidance, increasing the chances of entering incorrect information.

Issue: Users can easily make mistakes.

Suggested Improvement: Add input validation and clear instructions before form submission.

6. Recognition Rather Than Recall

Users often need to remember where categories and options are located because important features are not visually emphasized.

Issue: Navigation requires unnecessary memory.

Suggested Improvement: Highlight frequently used options and improve menu organization.

7. Flexibility and Efficiency of Use

The website offers basic search functionality but lacks modern filtering and sorting features that improve user efficiency.

Issue: Searching takes more time than necessary.

Suggested Improvement: Add filters, sorting options, and quick search suggestions.

8. Aesthetic and Minimalist Design

The interface contains large amounts of plain text with very little visual hierarchy. The design appears outdated compared to modern websites.

Issue: Poor visual appeal and readability.

Suggested Improvement: Introduce whitespace, icons, cards, improved typography, and modern colors.

9. Help Users Recognize, Diagnose, and Recover from Errors

When users make mistakes, the website provides limited guidance on how to correct them.

Issue: Error messages are not informative.

Suggested Improvement: Display clear error messages with suggestions for fixing the problem.

10. Help and Documentation

Help information is available but is not easy to locate or navigate.

Issue: Users may struggle to find support.

Suggested Improvement: Create a dedicated Help Center with FAQs, guides, and contact information.

Overall Evaluation

The Craigslist website is functional but follows an outdated design. Improving navigation, visual hierarchy, consistency, responsiveness, and user feedback would significantly enhance the user experience. A modern redesign with cleaner layouts, better typography, responsive design, and improved usability would make the website easier and more enjoyable to use.